

EMPOWERING SPACE

INDIA WILL SOON announce a new space policy that will define areas open to private entities, including start-ups. "We will be mindful of certain things to ensure our international commitments. Other than that, we aren't putting any barriers on the private sector," says Pawan Goenka, Chairperson, Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre. This will mean involvement of private players in manufacturing highly specialised equipment. Deliberations are also underway on finalising the FDI policy for the sector.

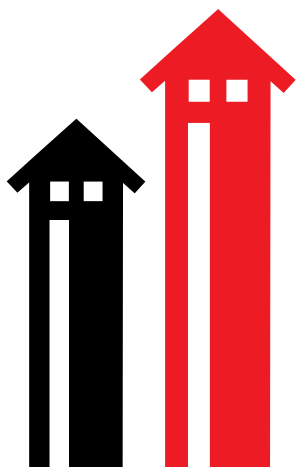
—MANISH PANT



EQUATED MONTHLY INCREASES

EMIs for home loan borrowers are set to rise with an increase of 0.5 per cent in the repo rate by the RBI. This is the second time the RBI has hiked the repo rate in 36 days. Banks have already started passing on the burden to borrowers. For example, HDFC has raised its benchmark retail prime lending rate (RPLR) by 50 basis points (bps), leading to a rise in home loan rates. The revised rate starts from 7.55 per cent and is effective from June 10. The loans benchmarked against repo or marginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR) will also see a jump in their home loan EMIs.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL



LIGHT YEARS AHEAD

After six years of innovation, the world's first production-ready solar car Lightyear o is here. Produced by Dutch start-up Lightyear, prices start at \$263,243 or ₹2.05 crore. Once it achieves critical mass, it can compete with luxury EV makers like Tesla, Porsche, etc. So efficient is it that drivers can travel for up to seven months on a single charge. Currently, Lightyear plans to build only 946 of these solar-powered vehicles every year. Time to grab one?

—PRERNA LIDHOO

₹10.41 LAKH CRORE

VALUE OF TRANSACTIONS UPI (UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE) PROCESSED IN MAY 2022, THE HIGHEST SINGLE-MONTH VALUE OF TRANSACTIONS SINCE ITS LAUNCH IN 2016

Dial C for Apple

TO CURB e-waste, EU lawmakers have mandated USB Type-C as the default charging port across smartphones, phones, tablets, cameras, etc., by fall 2024. The European Parliament says this will promote the re-use of chargers, saving up to €250 million a year on unnecessary charger purchases, and prevent up to 11,000 tonnes of e-waste annually. While most Android smartphones have embraced Type-C ports, the rule will also apply to iPhone giant Apple, which has been shipping phones with the proprietary 'Lightning' port. Not a difficult move as Apple has already adopted Type-C for iPads (except the iPad Mini).

—NIDHI SINGAL

